



K2 at The City School parent coffee morning August 2026

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We believe:

The formative years of childhood shape a life. We cherish them.

We envision:

A school that redefines what education can be when it is built around the child: where every child is known, understood, and valued. Where childhood is given the time and space to flourish. Where the foundations built give children the confidence to explore, to take risks, and to build lives of meaning and consequence.

We promise:

To honour each child as a born researcher, and to know who they are and how they learn.

To educate with academic rigour, and to deepen that knowledge inside Projects of research, where learning is built around your child's own questions.

To design spaces of beauty and intention where wonderings turn into discoveries.

To grow curiosity, confidence in their own voice, kindness in working with others, and the love of learning that a life is built on.

To welcome you inside that learning as our partner.

a family of schools



Y1&2



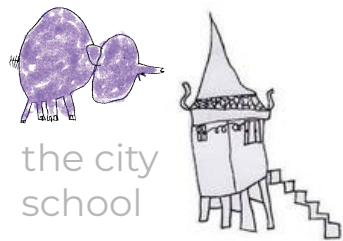
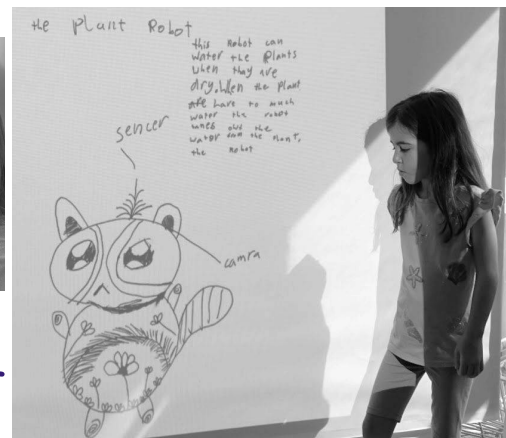
PURPLE ELEPHANT



K1&2



Y4+



the city school scholar

igniting each child's full potential

Striving for excellence through deliberate practice in the academic
languages of mathematics and literacy

Acting for the good of self and others, doing the right
thing for the right reasons, contributing kindness and
taking action

Innovative thinking and expression to generate new
ideas and solutions. Acting holistically through design
thinking. Logical yet agile



Nurturing the ability to analyze, evaluate, and
problem-solve, using research skills, thinking
routines and evidence-based dialogue

Harnessing the strengths of our community and
culture through teamwork, a connected
home/school environment, positive
relationships and valuing diversity

Effective and ethical verbal and non-verbal communication
skills, active listening, positive interactions

the city school

the environment is our third teacher

We're excited to have:

- a new atelier space, centrally located in Kindergarten for exploration of physics
- continued use of our outdoor space as an atelier for living and learning alongside nature

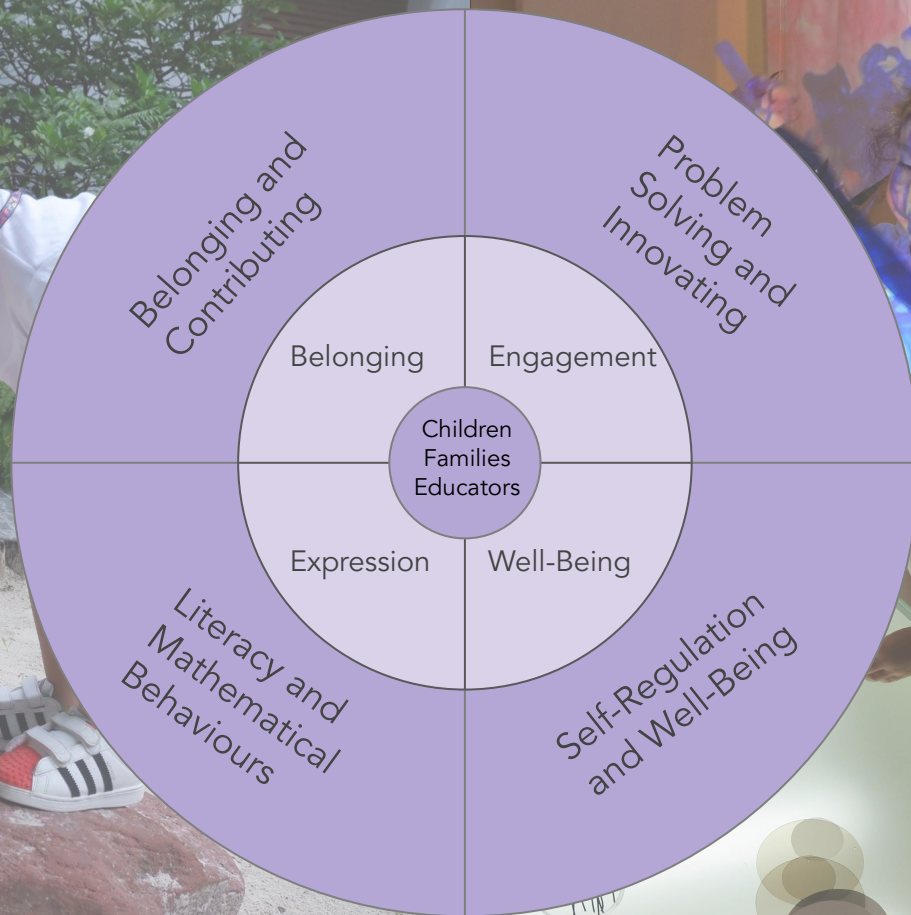


a Project based approach

- allows for contextual learning based on modern research and the **interests of the children**
- development of reflection skills and **metacognition**
- high level thinking skills that are fundamental across disciplines
- development of **critical thinkers** who can be flexible in the application of knowledge
- fosters the natural curiosity of children through asking questions, making **observations**, developing **hypotheses**, and forming **theories**



The Four Frames - Ontario Curriculum



belonging and contributing



- demonstrating self-confidence and empathy
- children see themselves as competent members of a bigger communities
- recognizing and drawing upon the unique skills and contributions of themselves others
- confidence to share ideas in a number of expressive languages
- first six weeks is spent developing trust and belonging to the classroom community

self-regulation and well-being

- confidence and independence
- understands roles and relationships with self, others, the community, and the environment
- mastery in independent self-care and physical health
- prosocial behaviour that allows for collaboration, sharing, and strong sense of identity
- continue developing understanding of natural physical limits through supported risk taking
- understanding the wide spectrum of human emotion and using learned strategies for dealing with them

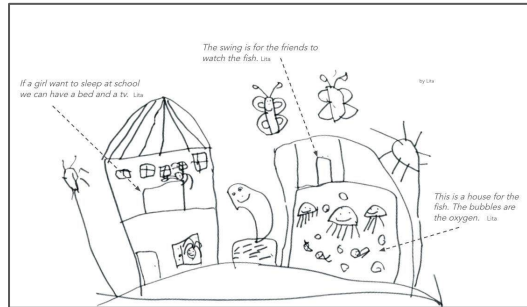
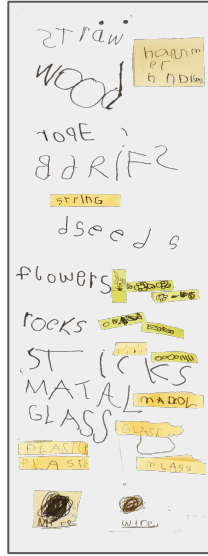
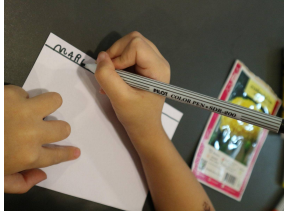


developmental milestones and education

Kindergarten 2 (4-5 years)	How do we support your child's development?
Physical Development • Increased proprioception and control of their body in smaller, relaxed spaces • Dominant hand has been decided by the child • Emergence of letter and word writing with lessening support over the year • Lots of physical movement required daily	<i>specialist classes</i> <i>mark making</i> <i>expressive languages</i> <i>communication centre</i> <i>supervised risk taking</i> <i>celebrating independence</i>
Social and Emotional Development • Engaging in more cooperative play throughout the year and across many areas of the classroom • Understand and rely on routines to independently regulate emotions • Challenging authority and asking for reasoning when given direction • Looking for approval from those around them, beginning to look to others for social references	<i>social stories and roleplay</i> <i>consistent routines</i> <i>project and collaboration</i> <i>self-expression</i> <i>encouraged independence</i> <i>Responsive Classroom</i>

demonstrating literacy and mathematical behaviours

jump on
the trampoline
morning
SLEEP



Mathematics

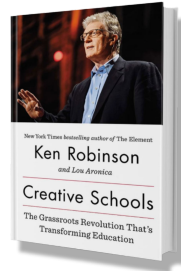
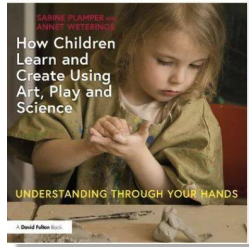
- Intentional instruction with play based reinforcement of concepts
- Principles of number
- Authentic contexts for learning through Project and other observations
- Spiral approach to curriculum standards allow for review and revision across a year

Literacy

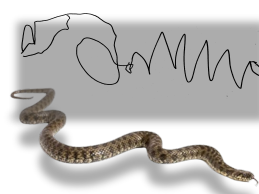
- Reading as a reader, reading as a writer
- Introduction to writing through bookmaking
- Formal reading programme begins in K2
- Speaking and communication
- Expressive languages

problem solving and innovating

- Project based approach to learning
- Encouraging children to develop skills that **transcend disciplines** such as critical and creative thinking, and problem solving
- Emphasis on **expressive languages** as a mode of thinking and learning
- **Play** as the primary tool for exploration and developing understanding
- **Authentic** and contextual contexts for discovery



available in the library



play

divergent thinking

Play creates encounters in which knowledge can move. A stick can become so many different things within play, the stick itself does not change, what changes is the relationship between the child, the stick (or whatever object the child is playing with), the situation and the meaning being created. **Play allows children to explore not only what something is, but what it might become.** Suzanne Axelsson

developmental milestones and education

Kindergarten 2 (4-5 years)

Cognitive Development

- Developing a longer attention span, often able to focus on a task for 15+ minutes on non-preferred tasks
- Counting to 20 and beyond; composing and decomposing numbers
- Beginning to explain more complex thinking
- Representing objects and ideas with increased detail
- Developing grapheme-phoneme relationships leading to reading

How do we support your child's development?

play-based learning *project*
authentic reading opportunities
hands-on experiences
theory development
mathematizing the world

Language Development

- Uses expressive oral language and has a vocabulary of over 2000 words
- Sentences will become longer and more complex; thoughts are clearly linked
- Asking a lot of "why" and "how" questions
- elaborate storytelling and imaginative play
- consistently use correct tenses when English is their native language, and developing understanding of tenses for ELL students

questioning *vocabulary expansion*
oral language skills
writing development *reading comprehension*

the role of the parent



in the first weeks of school:

- the day is longer so children may be tired, this can lead to undesirable or regressive behaviours
- maintain a consistent routine both at night, and in the morning before school
- keep in contact with your teacher so they know what's happening at home and can support children in the classroom

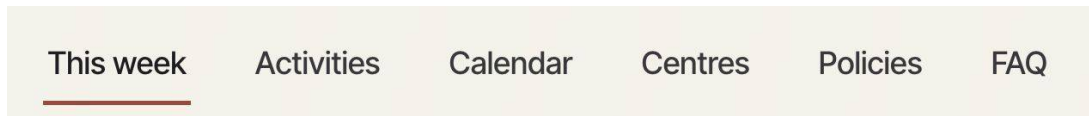
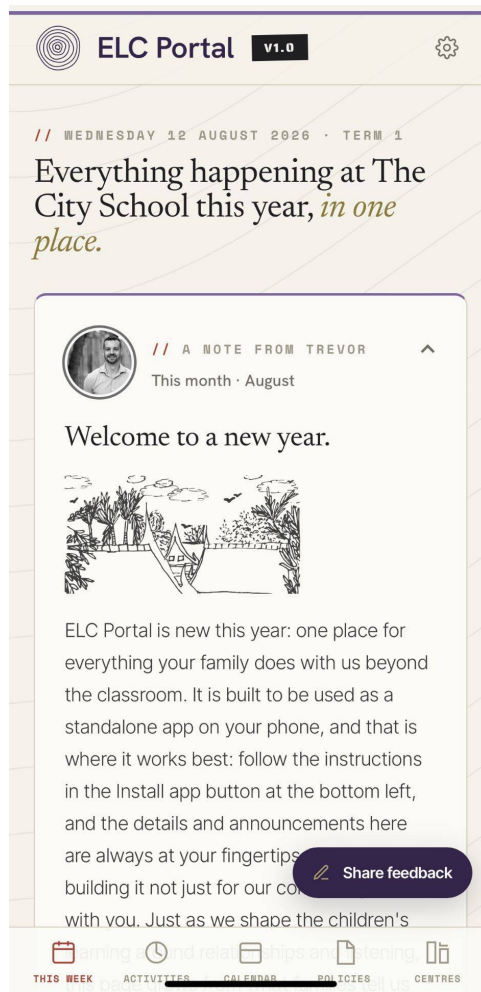
ongoing support

- engage in positive reciprocal relationships with educators, administrators and other families at The City School
- attend workshops and school events to stay up to date with what is happening on campus
- talk to your child about their day regularly using specific questions
- play with and read to your child often at at home; play is the work of children



whole school communication

Custom built - for us, by us! ELC Portal will be your go to source for information about everything happening across all our ELC campus. Find policies, parent handbooks, signups, event registration and more!



Parent

We want you to see what's happening in our classrooms! Teachers across the school will regularly update Parent App with posts about the amazing learning your children do every day. Photos are available for you to download and keep as memories of ELC for years to come.

We recommend that you tag your child in posts on a regular basis. When a child changes year level, all the previous year's posts will disappear.



safe and secure community

Emergency Operations Policy and Plan

- Earthquake
- Fire
- Lightning
- Flooding
- Lockdown
- Infectious diseases

At the City School, we maintain low teacher-child ratios so that we can continue to provide a high level of care to your children and get to know each child individually.

Safeguarding and Protection

- air quality - AQI
- nut-free school
- full time nurse on campus
- Data Protection Policies
 - E-Safety: phones, emails, videos
- guards, duties, lanyards
- designated adult toilets for parents/visitors
- duty of care
- Child Protection Policies

parent partnerships

At The City School, we partner with parents to ensure their child is developing competencies both academically and socially and emotionally.

We understand that it is important to know children, understand them, and support their growth and development not only in their current year levels, but beyond.

We prepare your children, throughout their time at The City School, to be ready for transitions to other schools and systems beyond Year 6. We view this as being partners in a child's learning journey for life.



the compass initiative

supporting your learning journey from birth through to adulthood



Developed in 2024-2025, the goal of The Compass Initiative is to provide families with personalized one to one guidance on future schools, both locally and internationally, for children within our community.

The Compass Initiative addresses our community promise of parents as partners and helps reinforce all four quadrants by sharing with parents not only advice on future schooling, but how we best prepare all children for the inevitable transition.



Pippa: ELC has helped me prepare for middle school with good teamwork skills, leadership skills, and the growth mindset that has helped me throughout the year such as helping me become a student leader in my year at NIST.

a bright future



At middle and high school level we recommend these schools for their excellent academic standing and pathways to international universities and a diverse student body (English is the language of the classroom, the halls and playground)

Our students predominantly enter these institutions as we prepare them Academically, Socially and Emotionally.

City School children thrive when they enter these schools. Possessed with a love for learning, the voice and confidence to handle a complex setting and excellent academics and 21st century skills.

getting in touch



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